

Tyler Rongxuan Chen

Curriculum Vitae

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EDUCATION

Degrees

Ph.D. Political Science and Scientific Computing: University of Michigan, 2023 – 2027 (Expected).

M.A. Statistics: University of Michigan, 2025 – 2027 (Expected).

M.A. Political Science: University of Michigan, 2023 – 2024.

M.A. International and Regional Studies (Southeast Asia): University of Michigan, 2021 – 2023.

B.A. Malay Studies, B.A. Diplomacy Studies: Beijing Foreign Studies University, 2016 – 2020.

Dissertation

Moving Ground: Three Papers on Elites, Voters, and the Breakdown of Dominant Party Systems.

Affiliates

The Michigan Institute for Computational Discovery and Engineering (MICDE)

International Institute (II): Center for Emerging Democracies (CED), Center for Southeast Asian Studies (CSEAS), and Lieberthal-Rogel Center for Chinese Studies (LRCCS)

Institute for Social Research (ISR): Population Studies Center (PSC), Center for Political Studies (CPS), and Stone Center for Inequality Dynamics (CID)

Non-Degree Study Experience

Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research (ICPSR), 2022, 2024, 2025.

Indiana University Summer Language Workshop (Japanese), 2024.

Exchange Student, Academy of Malay Studies, University of Malaya, 2018 – 2019.

RESEARCH

Book Project

The Tower of Babel We Bury: Geography, Group-Making, and the Communal Foundations of Party Systems.

Peer-reviewed Journal Articles

3. “Myth and Measurement: Spatial Heterogeneity, Ecological Fallacy, and the Urban Narrative in Peninsular Malaysia’s Electoral Politics”, *Journal of East Asian Studies* 26(1):87–112 [[Open Access](#)] [[Replication](#)].

2. “Malaysia’s Social Transformation and the Fragmentation of Malay Ethnic Parties: A Social Cleavage Structure Perspective” (with Congcong Fu), *Southeast Asian Studies* (东南亚研究) [*Chinese Social Sciences Citation Index (CSSCI)*] 2021(3):1-29 [[Chinese Full Text](#)] [[English Translation on SSRN-7118821](#)].
1. “Social Transformation, the Struggle over the Party Line, and the Split of Malaysia’s Islamic Party (PAS)” (with Congcong Fu), *Southeast Asian Affairs* (南洋问题研究) [*CSSCI*] 2020(1):79-95 [[Chinese Full Text](#)] [[English Translation on SSRN-7118822](#)].

Under Review

3. “The Front Page and the Back Room: Demand Narrowing, Elite Coordination, and the Survival of Authoritarian Elites”.
2. “Legible Domains: Colonial Rule, Social Density, and the Forms of Communal Politics in Malaysia and Indonesia”.
1. “Symbolic Power and the Functional Divide: Campaigns Across the Party-State Spectrum”.

Working Papers

6. “What Race and Ethnicity Hide: Bayesian Approximate Computation with Hierarchical Framework (BACH) for Subgroup Voting Behavior under Partisan Polarization, Cross-Cutting Cleavages, and Survey Nonresponse” [[SSRN-6610738](#)].
5. “Research Note: A Higher-Order Method of Moments Approach to Ecological Inference under Extreme Survey Nonresponse” [[SSRN-6610778](#)].
4. “What the Slope Loses, the Intercepts Gain: Measurement Error and Misattributed Effects in Fixed- and Random-Effects Models.” (with Robert Franzese) [[Latest Draft](#)].
3. “Written on the Soil: Why Urbanization Broke Only Half of an Electoral Authoritarian Regime” [Under Major Revision].
2. “Plant Closures and Trump-Related Twitter Discussion: A Spatial-Temporal Description” (with Robert Franzese) [[Latest Draft](#)].
1. “Dancing with Hands Tied: Elite Defection, Social Constraints, and the Breakdown of Dominant-Party Systems” [[SSRN-7123960](#)].

Work in Progress

2. “Theorizing Party-State Spectrum: From U.S. Southern Enclaves to China” (with Mary Gallagher).
1. “Three Clocks of the Aging Electorate: Period, Cohort, and the Misread Stability of the Senior Bloc in Japan and South Korea” (with Wooseok Kim).

Data Sets

2. “Malaysia Election Panel Data 1959 - 2018”, *Available at [Zenodo](#)*.
1. “Lower Chamber Elections Archive, Malaysia”, *Available at the [Constituency-Level Elections Archive \(CLEA\)](#)*.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant (Graduate Level), ICPSR

“Theoretical Modeling for the Social and Behavioral Sciences”, David A. Peterson, 2025

“Causal Inference for the Social Sciences I”, Ben Hansen, Jake Bowers, 2025

Tutor (Graduate Level), University of Michigan

POLSCI 599 “Applied Statistical Methods for Political and Social Science Research”, Tyler Simko, Fall 2026

POLSCI 599 “Statistical Methods in Political Research I”, Licheng Liu, Fall 2025

Graduate Student Instructor, University of Michigan

POLSCI 373 “Data Science for International Studies”, Christopher Fariss, Winter 2026

POLSCI 300 “Quantitative Empirical Methods”, Rob Franzese, Fall 2025

POLSCI 327 “Election Law”, Jowei Chen, Winter 2025

POLSCI 140 “Intro to Comparative Politics”, Pauline Jones, Fall 2024

POLSCI 389 “Human Rights”, Ragnhild Nordås, Winter 2023

SOC 430 “World Population Dynamics”, Barbara Anderson, Fall 2022

AWARDS, GRANTS, & FELLOWSHIPS

University of Michigan

MICDE Fellowship, 2026

Department of Political Science Director of Graduate Studies (DGS) Research Grant, 2026

ISR Next Generation Award – The Tessler Fellows Fund, 2026

Rackham Graduate Student Research Grants, 2022, 2026

Advanced Research Computing Grant, 2026

Political Science Department DGS Conference Travel Grant, 2024, 2026

ISR – Rackham Summer Training Awards, 2024, 2025

Rackham Graduate School Conference Travel Grant, 2024, 2025

College of Literature, Science, and the Arts (LSA) Technology Support Grant, 2024

Center for Japanese Studies Summer Language Fellowship, 2024

Political Science Department Research Grant, 2023, 2024

University Library Research Grant, 2023

CED Fellowship, 2022

II Student Fellowship, 2022

II Travel Funds, 2022

Global Individual Grants, 2022

CSEAS Southeast Asian Language Scholarship (Indonesian), 2021

Beijing Foreign Studies University

Excellent Senior Thesis Award for Both Degrees, 2020

University Scholarships, 2017, 2018, 2019

External

American Political Science Association (APSA) Democracy and Autocracy Section Travel Award, 2026

The Society for Political Methodology (PolMeth) Conference Travel Award, 2025

Phi Kappa Phi Honor Society, 2023

Beijing Outstanding Graduate, 2020

CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOPS

Conference Presentations

APSA Annual Meeting, 2024, 2025, 2026

PolMeth Annual Summer Meeting, 2025, 2026

Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Annual Meeting, 2025

American Sociological Association (ASA) Annual Meeting, 2024, 2025

Social Science History Association (SSHA) Annual Meeting, 2024

Workshops

The Japanese Politics Online Seminar Series (JPOSS), 2026

CED Book Workshop with Joel Selway, 2024

SERVICE TO DEPARTMENT, UNIVERSITY, & PROFESSION

Graduate Education and Training in Southeast Asian Studies (GETSEA) Consortium

Graduate Student Council Member, 2023 – 2026

University of Michigan

Co-Organizer, China Reading Group, 2023 –

Graduate Student Representative, Department of Political Science Hiring Committee, 2026

Member, LSA Graduate Student Advisory Council (GSAC), 2025 – 2026

Co-President, Graduate Association of Political Scientists (GAPS), 2025 – 2026

Member, Political Science Honors Thesis Committee, 2025

Mentor, The Eldersveld Emerging Scholars Conference, 2024

Co-Organizer, Interdisciplinary Workshop in Comparative Politics, 2023 – 2024

Journal Referee

Social Forces, Comparative Political Studies, Field Methods

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

NielsenIQ

Business Analyst (Consumer Packaged Goods Section, Beijing Office), 2020 – 2021

LANGUAGES AND SKILLS

Languages

Mandarin Chinese (Native), English (Bilingual Proficiency), Malay (Advanced, ~10 years), Indonesian (Advanced, ~5 years), Japanese (Intermediate, ~2.5 years)

Skills

R, Python, Stata, Stan, ArcGIS, NetLogo, C++, L^AT_EX, High-Performance Computing (SLURM), Bash Scripting, Parallel Job Management

FIELDWORK

Malaysia (Kuala Lumpur, Selangor, Pulau Penang, Terengganu, Melaka, Johor; ~ 1 year), Singapore (~ 3 months), the United States (Novi, MI; Dearborn, MI; New York City, NY; Atlanta, GA; Milwaukee, WI; ~ 1 year)

REFERENCES

Robert Franzese

Professor of Political Science
University of Michigan
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Allen Hicken

Professor of Political Science
University of Michigan
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Mary Gallagher

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